

SEASON 01 EPISODE 11

Hey June, Wanna Play

1 **EXT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT**

1

A trashed car. The WHEELS SPIN.

LOUIS, a brown bear, and JUNIPER, a black lab, sit inside.

Louis's car SPINS back to the road.

2 **INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT**

2

JUNIPER

Go!

Louis FLOORS IT.

The car dashes through the forest, along bumps.

The vulture LANDS right in front of the car.

JUNIPER

Back, back, back!

Juniper reverses. Louis floors it again.

The avian flies toward them.

Louis spins, pulling the car back.

Juniper places his hands on the ceiling.

JUNIPER

Aaaah!

Louis tries to switch. Realizes he has to brake. Brakes,
then switches to forward-

RAMS AS FAST AS HE CAN- INTO THE BIRD.

The bird dodges.

JUNIPER

(points)

That way!

LOUIS

I know, I know, I know!

Juniper grabs his phone-

But Louis FLOORS it again.

Juniper's phone DROPS to the floor.

He picks it up, tries to call 911-

No service. He goes on maps-

It loads from the cache.

JUNIPER
Go, go, go this way!

LOUIS
Which way?!

JUNIPER
This- that! Left!

Louis turns.

JUNIPER
Okay! Wait turn around!

LOUIS
Why?!

Juniper's on the map. The road converges back, south.

JUNIPER
Just turn around!

The bird RAMS into Louis's tire, popping it. But Louis floors it-

JUNIPER
Faster, faster, faster!

It CRASHES into the back. Louis floors it.

The bird tries to wrestle inside, but Louis turns sharp right, tossing the bird off.

Louis VROOMS toward the highway.

He hits a pebble, a boulder, a rock, scratching the car-
THEN IT FALLS, into a ravine.

Louis gets stuck again. The bird flies-

They rush out of the vehicle.

LOUIS
No, no, no no no no!

Louis crawls away, panicking, glancing everywhere. He reaches back inside.

Juniper catches him.

JUNIPER
The hell are you doing?!

LOUIS
Th-there's important shit in there!

JUNIPER
The engine's steaming!

Louis wrestles free- reaches into the glove compartment,
brings out what he can.

STUFFS THEM INTO HIS BACKPACK.

LOUIS
Go, go, go go go!

Louis takes Juniper's hand, and they run. They look back,
but there's nothing.

JUNIPER
What happened? What was that?

LOUIS
I don't know! Avian?!

JUNIPER
Is this the fucking serial killer
shit we talked about?!

LOUIS
Not funny!

A footrace down the hill as-

JUNIPER
Behind! Behind!

THE FIGURE SWOOPS UP.

Louis turns around, glaring at the vulture-

3 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

3

Louis falls on the floor, covering his eye.

HAZEL
You're not my brother!

LOUIS
(crying)
And you're not my sister!

4 EXT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

4

All the strength in Louis's arms-

He CHANNELS IT, and GRABS hold of the pair of talens
coming right for them.

LOUIS

Hg-nahhh!

He tosses the bird, FLINGING it against a tree. He flings it again.

Juniper fumbles with whatever he can. No weapon.

He rushes in.

LOUIS

Get away!

The bird restles free, then KICKS Louis, sending him to the ground.

Juniper leaps toward, but clutches his side as he falls to the ground.

JUNIPER

Louis!

The bird flies for Louis. He grabs a talon and SWINGS IT.

The bird is RAMMED into a tree. It lets out a squawk.

A shrill squawk. It can't get up. Its leg is twisted.

Juniper grabs Louis's hand and they RUN. Juniper clutching his side.

5 EXT. CAVE - NIGHT

5

Juniper brings Louis to the entrance of a small cave. They pin themselves against the wall, into the dark.

Juniper brings out his flashlight- checks the walls.

They dash into the cave. There's an opening on the other side.

But to their right, they notice: A flow of water, heading further underground.

LOUIS

Hide, bitch, hide.

Juniper and Louis hide behind a rock, in the tunnel.

As a bird SWOOPS by the open area.

The two boys push further in-

But FALL, far.

They land on the ground.

The two boys, shivering, sit against the wall, in the dark.

Louis breathes deep, slow.

Juniper puts his arm around Louis's back, staring ahead to check for anything.

Juniper brings out his phone and checks. No signal.

But Louis wraps his arms around him and leans.

Juniper leans back.

JUNIPER

Louis...

Louis looks up.

LOUIS

Send Eve your location, just do it.

Louis brings out his phone and does just that. Juniper does the same.

LOUIS

We have to move, otherwise we won't get service.

JUNIPER

I can't see shit.

They turn on their flashlights. They're deep in a cave system.

LOUIS

June, what?

They glance back up to the top.

It's steep, but a doable climb.

The two boys pin themselves against the walls of the cave. Their eyes wide.

JUNIPER

Where are we?

Louis grabs Juniper, pulls him closer.

JUNIPER

(whispering)

Louis, I'm scared.

LOUIS

We're gonna get out of here.

They hear FLAPPING coming from outside the cave.

LOUIS
We gotta wait until the coast is
clear.

JUNIPER
Louis, I- I smell something.

The two hold hands. They walk closer to one side of the
cave-

But a stench sends their hairs spining.

The two boys' breathing grows faster as they DASH up the
cave.

They make it back to the surface-

The coast is clear. They hold hands and run.

6 EXT. FOREST - NIGHT

6

They run, until Juniper falls to the ground.

JUNIPER
I'm tired, Louis.

Louis looks around. Looks like the coast is clear.

Louis sits alongside Juniper.

JUNIPER
I think we're safe... Let's just
rest.

Louis scoots alongside Juniper, clutching his side.

They grab fallen leaves and throw them over their bodies,
masking themselves.

LOUIS
We'll move in the day. If we're
unfamiliar, then it's best to assume
whatever attacked us knows more than
we do.

They lower to a whisper.

JUNIPER
I can't believe it... What are the
odds?

The night is still.

JUNIPER
That we encounter a fucking serial
killer on the one day we were
supposed to make it out?

Louis's eyes dart.

LOUIS
June... I know this is gonna sound
stupid...

Louis gulps.

LOUIS
But my dad had a downpayment for
that car.

The two boys chuckle, quietly.

Then they close their eyes.

A tear comes out from Juniper's.

While Louis shivers, cold.

7 **EXT. FOREST - DAY**

7

Louis slowly opens his eyes.

The mildew is fresh. Louis shifts-

But feeling Juniper's hand, his eyes shift.

Something's wrong.

LOUIS
June?

Louis shakes June.

LOUIS
June? June, are you awake? You're
really cold. Want-

Louis shakes him, but his eyebrows narrow.

He lifts his finger.

The blanket is soaked in blood.

LOUIS
June?

JUNIPER
Louis... what's happening?

Louis's eyes dart around. He grabs Juniper's body and HOISTS it around his back.

LOUIS

Come on.

He runs out of the cave. Glancing around:

Coast is clear.

Louis glances at his phone. No service.

Panting, he makes his way up the hill.

He whips out his phone, glances at the maps.

He's lost.

8 EXT. FOREST - DAY

8

And as the day starts-

9 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

9

The sun comes up. Eve's phone still has nothing from Louis and Juniper.

EVE

I- I don't know, they're not answering.

PETUNIA (V.O.)

They were supposed to call me last night?

EVE

Maybe they forgot. I just wanna make sure, because where are they if they're not...

FERGIE

You didn't ask once to share locations?

EVE

I- I just- we've been in Talens for our entire lives, there was no need to-

FERGIE

But still, Eve.

Eve frowns.

10 INT. PETUNIA'S CAR - DAY

10

The sun begins to rise.

PATTY, Petunia's aunt, arrives at the area. THEY DON'T NOTICE THE TURNOUT SIGN.

PATTY
Petunia, just let it go, alright?
They're fine. It's a bear and a dog,
for goodness sakes. And they're both
boys.

PETUNIA
It's just that they promised they'd
stay in touch.

ROSALINE
They also did just run away from
their parents.

Patty turns around.

PATTY
Excuse me? You're telling me they
ran away?

Petunia and Rosaline nod.

PATTY
And you're just enabling that?

The car goes silent.

11 EXT. CICADA - DAY

11

The sun rises fully-

As taller, redwood trees shake the horizon.

Petunia and Rosaline smile, but a quiet piano accompanies them.

The sky is clear.

PETUNIA
Well, I hope when everyone sees
this, they'll flip out.

Rosaline grabs Petunia's hand.

12 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - DAY

12

The car breezes through the wind. As Fergie turns on the radio:

The kids karaoke, their instruments shaking in the back.

13 **EXT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY** 13

Patty's car slides to a halt. The girls flood out.

THE DOOR OPENS TO:

14 **INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY** 14

Loads of beavers, RUSHING PETUNIA.

PETUNIA

Woah!

Patty hugs Petunia's mother and father- LETTY and JOSE.

OVER LUNCH:

LETTY

Suzie won four metals, Petunia!

PETUNIA

Really, Mom? I wanna see!

Petunia glances at her cousin- SUZIE- winning so many.

Suzie runs down and hugs Patty.

Beavers everywhere, crashing into furniture, bumping into the TV.

JOSE

Hey, hey, hey, calm down, kids!

Petunia smiles. But she glances at Rosaline, talking with Letty in the kitchen.

To her left: A car arrives.

Outside steps an otter, Rosaline's father. FISHER.

FISHER

Rosaline!

Rosaline gasps. She hugs Petunia.

ROSALINE

Be back at 5!

PETUNIA

Okay!

15 **INT. FISHER'S CAR - DAY** 15

Two otters in a huge, rugged truck.

Fisher, with a baseball cap and tank top, sits in silence with Rosaline.

FISHER
 (awkward)
 So how was it? Being in your aunt
 Patty's... house. For almost half a
 decade.

ROSALINE
 It was good, Dad.

16 **EXT. FOREST - DAY** 16

The car passes through redwood trees.

FISHER (O.S.)
 You're so big now, dear.

17 **INT. FISHER'S CAR - DAY** 17

ROSALINE
 Big? I'm big?

Fisher raises his eyebrows in confusion, then chuckles.

FISHER
 So you've seen the world.

18 **EXT. FISHER'S HOME - DAY** 18

Fisher parks at a tall, barn-like home, straight out of
 Stardew Valley.

Rosaline glances at it with sparkly eyes.

19 **EXT. FOREST - DAY** 19

Louis huffs... Huffs... Huffs. He falls to the ground.

But hoists himself back up.

20 **INT. FISHER'S HOME - DAY** 20

Fisher moves around a wooden sculpture of a boat, fishing
 tackles. He puts on a news broadcast of BULLOCK- the
 current president.

FISHER
 Just as you remember it, kid.
 Everything's here.

Rosaline smiles at her father. But she glances at the news
 broadcast of Bullock.

Her smile drops.

FISHER
 What's the matter, dear?

ROSALINE

Uh... Dad? What's your opinion on Bullock?

FISHER

You mean President Bullock.

Rosaline glances at her food, glaring, eyes half-closed.

FISHER

Listen, kid.

(deep breath)

His whole thing's efficiency. If you're not efficient, he won't reward you.

Fishing trophies, statues, all over the house.

ROSALINE

But Dad, that means he'd go so far as to-

FISHER

Cut off the salaries of the species he doesn't consider "efficient?" Yeah, well, that doesn't affect us, you know.

ROSALINE

True, but, Dad, you know what's crazy? I'm friends with a bear.

Fisher turns around, shocked.

FISHER

He scare you in any way?

ROSALINE

No, Dad, he's actually really sweet.

Fisher nods.

ROSALINE

And I feel like, if the government just gave his family a second shot, he'd be capable of so much more.

Fisher lowers his head to the floor.

ROSALINE

I don't know.

Fisher gets up and turns off the TV. He heads to Rosaline.

FISHER

Kid... come on. Come with me.

21 **EXT. FISHER'S HOME - DAY**

21

Fisher brings out a rod.

FISHER
You remember how to do this?

Rosaline shakes her head. Fisher hands her the rod- hooks a little worm.

Rosaline makes a face. Fisher chuckles.

FISHER
Toss.

Fisher makes a motion. Rosaline copies.

FISHER
You're a natural. Okay, now wait.

Fisher sits down next to her.

FISHER
Anyone else?

ROSALINE
Then there's a dog. He lives on my street. He's really smart. His brother passed away last week, though.

FISHER
Was it a-

ROSALINE
It was a suicide.

Fisher nods, slow.

ROSALINE
So, I don't know.

Fisher stares out into the world.

FISHER
You know, kid- life's hard. This kind of stuff happens more often than you think it does.

ROSALINE
(unsure)
But I saw it, Dad. I saw people protesting, fighting, people turning on their own kind. And I can't look away now, you know?

Fisher nods.

FISHER
You don't have to look away, but we
have our role in society, you know.

ROSALINE
I know, Dad, but it's that bad.

Fisher sighs. He glances down.

FISHER
Patty told me you applied to big
universities?

ROSALINE
A law university in Fjord. Two in
Cicada. There's one near Talens.
(a beat)
I made the one in Fjord.

Fisher nods slowly.

FISHER
Sure you don't wanna do a simple
life here?

Rosaline shakes her head.

Fisher sits, bites his lip. His eyes well.

Then a FISH BITES.

Rosaline reels, reels, reels-

FISHER
Go, go, get 'em!

Rosaline tries-

And the line comes out with a halibut.

The halibut flops and screams.

ROSALINE
Shit!

Fisher cackles as Rosaline fumbles with the fish. The two
fumble with it, the fish slipping away- until they both
catch it.

22 INT. FISHER'S HOME - DAY

22

The two grill the fish on Fisher's stove. Fisher and
Rosaline sit, thigh to thigh.

FISHER
Mom would be proud of you.

23 EXT. FOREST - DAY**23**

Louis checks his phone. SIGNAL.

He drops Juniper lightly.

Louis frantically dials 911. It rings- it rings-

But he loses it.

JUNIPER

I'm sorry...

Louis's head whips to Juniper.

LOUIS

(exhausted)

June, stay with me, please.

JUNIPER

...John...

Louis buries his head in his hands. He dials 911 again.

He tries texting Eve. Petunia. Rosaline.

Mom. Dad.

Nothing.

Louis sends one last message to his mother:

"I LOVE YOU"

Before picking Juniper up.

24 EXT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY**24**

Rosaline returns with Fisher. Set up, in the backyard:

Fergie and the gang.

FERGIE

Hey, Rosaline! Check this out!

Fergie riffs. Petunia's family cheers. So does Rosaline.

ROSALINE

(chuckles)

Where's Petunia?

EVE

She's in the house!

25 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY

25

Petunia glances at a family photo of her and her father.
Beavers in construction.

She glances at it with Letty.

LETTY
You excited to start here?

Petunia nods. But her eyes falter.

LETTY
You used to be so quiet when you
were a little baby.

PETUNIA
(chuckles)
Me? Quiet?

Patty smiles.

PETUNIA
With everything going on in the
world, I'd say we're pretty lucky,
Mom.

Patty and Petunia hug.

PETUNIA
You know Eve?

Patty nods.

ROSALINE
She was homeschooled.
(hugs tighter)
Her parents died when she was
little.
(shrugs)
It kind of sucks, Mom.

LETTY
Don't pity her.

PETUNIA
Well, it's more like- if she was
given more, I think she would be
happier with herself, you know?

Letty glances at Petunia.

PETUNIA
She would be like, more proud of
what she makes. And less scared.

LETTY

Maybe she wouldn't work as hard if she wasn't as scared.

PETUNIA

Mom, but- that's the problem with the way this family thinks.

Petunia glances at her family photo.

PETUNIA

What's this thing about small animals being hard workers? What if I wanna be lazy and lay in bed all day?

LETTY

Well then you're not a hard worker.

PETUNIA

But like- why do I have to keep moving, Mom? Why do any of us small animals have to keep moving?

Letty places her hand on Petunia's shoulder.

LETTY

Because until we get better pay, better money, this is what we have to work with.

Petunia crosses her arms.

LETTY

The moment small animals stop presenting themselves as "safe," as "efficient-"

PETUNIA

But I don't wanna be presentable.

LETTY

I know that. We all do. But we have money, and it's like you said. We're lucky.

Petunia's shoulders droop. She sits on the bed.

She glances around the room, at family photo after family photo.

She plays with a napkin.

PETUNIA

Mom, the world sucks. It actually fucking sucks.

Letty sits with her.

LETTY
Well, over summer, when you're
officially we can talk more about
it. I promise. But let's get
graduation over with, okay?

Petunia nods.

Her and Letty hug.

LETTY
Love you.

PETUNIA
Love you.

26 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - NIGHT

26

Petunia leaves the room. Rosaline's in the hallway. They wave.

Outside, while the band plays, distant, grabbing fruits from the fridge:

ROSALINE
I really feel like Louis and June
should be here.

PETUNIA
I know. I've been thinking about
that all day.

ROSALINE
You think they got lost?

Quisha PEEKS in.

QUISHA
Hey, bitches. Where the boys at?

PETUNIA
That's what we're talking about.

QUISHA
You telling me no one got a hold of
them?

Dax peeks in.

DAX
Did you ask them-

QUISHA
Yeah. Nothing.

Petunia and Rosaline glance at each other.

Eve peeks in, calling them on the phone, panting. She high-fives Fergie.

27 EXT. FOREST - NIGHT

27

The sun is setting. Louis's hand shakes. He wipes sweat on his forehead.

LOUIS

June?

JUNIPER

Nn...

Louis's lip quivers. He whips out his phone. Service is one bar.

He dials 911, but-

Eve calls.

Louis sighs, falls to the floor.

LOUIS

(morbid)

Eve...

28 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - NIGHT

28

Eve stops.

LOUIS (V.O.)

Eve... Thank god...

Eve glances around at the crew. Fergie turns to her. She holds up her finger.

LOUIS (V.O.)

(raspy)

If anyone, it should've been you.

Eve's eyes go wide.

LOUIS (V.O.)

I don't think I'm gonna make it...

EVE

What? This is not funny. We've been waiting for you all fucking day. Don't pull this shit.

Eve puts Louis on speaker.

LOUIS (V.O.)
June's beside me. Do you have
anything to say?

JUNIPER (V.O.)
(delirious)
Let me inside... Mom... Please...
Let me inside...

Eve's eyes go wide. Everyone springs into action.

EVE
C-call 911. Someone go, go, go.

FERGIE
I'm calling them. I'm calling them.

DAX
Did you crash?!

EVE
I don't know- guys!

LOUIS
(laughing)
Ah, is everyone there? Thank god. I
should call Mom.

EVE
Wait, Louis, where are you?

LOUIS
I'm...
(laughs)
I'm sorry, Eve.

EVE
Northbound to Cicada? Where are you?

LOUIS
...Yes.

Eve points. Rosaline brings up the northbound highway,
highway 96.

Petunia on the phone with the operator.

OPERATOR
Highway 96, northbound to Cicada.

LOUIS
Turnout...

EVE
On a turnout! On a turnout!

OPERATOR

Okay.

EVE

What happened? Did you crash?

LOUIS

Yes.

Eve sits. The entire room goes quiet.

EVE

What did you have for lunch yesterday?

Louis goes quiet.

EVE

Hey, please?

Silence. Complete silence.

The group RUSHES.

FERGIE

Go, go, go. Dax! Keys!

Dax throws Fergie the keys. The group runs outside.

Eve falls to the floor, hyperventilating. Petunia picks her up. They run outside.

Fergie's car starts-

29 EXT. HOSPITAL - NIGHT

29

As ambulances are dispatched.

30 INT. JANE'S CAR - NIGHT

30

JANE, Juniper's mother, drives with BELINDA, HENRY, and HAZEL, Louis's mother, father, and sister.

Louis's father's head is buried in his hands.

Jane gets a call.

JANE

Hello? Who is this?

PATTY

Jane, we- we found-

BELINDA

(sigh)

Thank god!

PATTY
No, no, no! It's bad! Send- go to
the location we sent!

JANE
D-did they-

PATTY
Yes! They crashed!

The family sits up.

BELINDA
Well you heard them, go!
Jane, through gritted teeth, FLOORS it.

31 EXT. FOREST - NIGHT

31

Louis crawls to Juniper. He hugs Juniper.

JUNIPER (V.O.)
What's your name?

LOUIS (V.O.)
Louis.

JUNIPER (V.O.)
You have small ears.

Louis pauses, then chuckles.

JUNIPER (V.O.)
And I have big ears. And I have a
long tail.

LOUIS (V.O.)
Mine is really short.

JUNIPER (V.O.)
It's kinda bushy.

LOUIS (V.O.)
(laughs)
Yeah, I guess.

A long pause. As Louis's eyes begin to fade, he asks
Juniper one last question.

LOUIS
Hey June... Wanna play?

He closes his eyes.

Ambulance lights- red and blue appears from above.

As Louis stops shivering, and his body finally rests.

CUT TO BLACK.